

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

- Answer Choices:
- A. visual system
 - B. thalamus
 - C. frontal lobe
 - D. brain stem
 - E. parietal lobe
 - F. cerebellum
 - G. cortex
 - H. basal ganglia
 - I. hypothalamus
 - J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

</tool_call> reasoning process here

At birth , the brain undergoes rapid development , with certain regions developing earlier than others . The brain stem , which controls basic life -sustaining functions like breathing and heart rate , is one of the first parts to develop and is present very early in embryogenesis . In contrast , the cerebral cortex , especially the frontal lobe and association areas , is the most recently developed part of the brain and is not fully developed at birth . The cortex , which is responsible for higher cognitive functions like reasoning , decision-making , and problem-solving , matures gradually over the first few years of life . Therefore , the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cortex , particularly the prefrontal cortex which is not fully formed until adolescence . While other structures like the limbic system and thalamus are somewhat developed , the cerebral cortex (especially its higher-order areas) is the most delayed in development .

Hence , the correct answer is the cortex .

<answer>G</answer>

